

Ἰωάννης ὁ Κανᾶνος

John Cananus on the Siege of Constantinople

eul_aid: tdi

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Βυζαντινὴ Ἑλληνικὴ [Byzantine Greek](#)
Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

John Cananus was a 15th-century Byzantine historian. His life is obscure, though his name likely indicates an origin from Cananus in Lydia or Cannae. He is known only as the author of an eyewitness account of the Ottoman siege of Constantinople in 1422, written in a simple, vernacular Greek style.

His sole known work is **The Account of the Siege of Constantinople by the Turks**, also called **The Siege of Constantinople in 1422**. This prose narrative provides a detailed description of the military events and the roles of Emperors Manuel II Palaiologos and John VIII during the Ottoman assault.

Cananus's account is a valuable primary source for the final century of the Byzantine Empire, offering a detailed, contemporary perspective from within the besieged city. Its use of vernacular Greek provides important linguistic data for the period. While less stylistically sophisticated than classicizing histories, its immediacy and specific detail make it crucial for understanding the military and social conditions of the early 15th-century Byzantine world.

Works (1)

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